Test 4:

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

Pearls

A

Long known as the “Queen of Gems”, pearls possess a history and allure far beyond what today’s wearer may recognize. Throughout much of recorded history, a natural pearl necklace comprised of matched spheres was a treasure of almost incomparable value, in fact, the most expensive jewelry in the world. Before the creation of cultured pearls in the early 1900s, natural pearls were so rare and expensive that they were reserved almost exclusively for the noble and very rich. The ancient Egyptians were particularly fond of their pearls. Many Egyptian leaders treasured pearls so much that they were often buried along with their cherished pearl collection. In the Orient and Persian Empire, pearls were ground into costly powders to cure anything from heart disease to epilepsy, with possible aphrodisiac uses as well. China’s long recorded history also provides ample evidence of the importance of pearls.

B

Pearls usually fall into three categories—natural pearls, cultured pearls and simulated pearls. A natural pearl forms when an irritant, such as a piece of sand, works its way into a particular species of oyster, mussel, or clam. As a defense mechanism, the mollusk secretes a fluid to coat the irritant. Layer upon layer of this coating is deposited on the irritant until a lustrous pearl is formed.

A cultured pearl undergoes the same process. The only difference between natural pearls and cultured pearls is that the irritant is a surgically implanted bead or piece of shell called Mother of Pearl. Often, these shells are ground oyster shells that are worth significant amounts of money in their own right as irritant-catalysts for quality pearls. The resulting core is much larger than in a natural pearl.

Imitation pearls are a different story altogether. In most cases, a glass bead is dipped into a solution made from fish scales. This coating is thin and may eventually wear off. One can usually tell an imitation by biting on it. The island of Mallorca in Spain is known for its imitation pearl industry.

C

Regardless of the method used to acquire a pearl, the process usually takes several years. Mussels must reach a mature age, which can take up to 3 years, and then be implanted or naturally receive an irritant. Once the irritant is in place, it can take up to another 3 years for the pearl to reach its full size. Often, the irritant may be rejected, the pearl will be terrifically misshapen, or the oyster may simply die from disease or countless other complications. By the end of a 5 to 10 year cycle, only 50% of the oysters will have survived. And of the pearls produced, only approximately 5% are of a quality substantial enough for top jewelry makers.

D

How can untrained eyes determine a pearl's worth? Luster and size are generally considered the two main factors to look for. Luster, for instance, depends on the fineness and evenness of the layers. The deeper the glow, the more perfect the shape and surface, the more valuable they are.

Size, on the other hand, has to do with the age of the oyster that created the pearl (the more mature oysters produce larger pearls) and the location in which the pearl was cultured. The South Sea waters of Australia tend to produce the larger pearls; probably because the water along the coastline is supplied with rich nutrients from the ocean floor. Also, the type of mussel being common to the area seems to possess a predilection for producing comparatively large pearls.

E

In general, cultured pearls are less valuable than natural pearls, whereas imitation pearls have almost no value. One way that jewelers can determine whether a pearl is cultured or natural is to have a gem lab perform an X-ray of the pearl.

If the X-ray reveals a nucleus, the pearl is likely a bead nucleated saltwater pearl. If no nucleus is present, but irregular and small dark inner spots indicating a cavity are visible, combined with concentric rings of organic substance, the pearl is likely a cultured freshwater pearl.

Among cultured pearls, Akoya pearls from Japan are some of the most lustrous. Although imitation pearls look the part, they do not have the same weight or smoothness as real pearls, and their luster will also dim greatly.

F

Historically, the world's best pearls came from the Persian Gulf, especially around what is now Bahrain. The pearls of the Persian Gulf were naturally created and collected by breath-hold divers. Unfortunately, the natural pearl industry of the Persian Gulf ended abruptly in the early 1930s with the discovery of large deposits of oil.

The water pollution resulting from spilled oil and indiscriminate overfishing of oysters essentially ruined the pristine waters of the Gulf that once produced pearls. Still, Bahrain remains one of the foremost trading centers for high quality pearls. In fact, cultured pearls are banned from the Bahrain pearl market, in an effort to preserve the location's heritage.

Nowadays, the largest stock of natural pearls probably resides in India. Ironically, much of India's stock of natural pearls came originally from Bahrain. Unlike Bahrain, which has essentially lost its pearl resource, traditional pearl fishing is still practiced on a small scale in India.

G

Pearls also come in many colours. The most popular colours are white, cream, and pink. Silver, black, and gold are also gaining interest. In fact, a deep lustrous black pearl is one of the rarest finds in the pearling industry, usually only being found in the South Sea near Australia. Thus, they can be one of the more costly items.

Nowadays, pearls predominantly come from Japan, Australia, Indonesia, Myanmar, China, India, the Philippines, and Tahiti. Japan, however, controls roughly 80% of the world pearl market, with Australia and China coming in second and third, respectively.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 1–4

Reading Passage 1 has seven paragraphs, A–G.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, A–G, in boxes 1–4 on your answer sheet.

1. difficulties in the cultivation process

2. causes affecting the size of natural pearls

3. ancient customs around pearls

4. distinctions between cultured pearls and natural ones

Questions 5–10

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–K,** below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–K**, in boxes 5–10 on your answer sheet.*

Throughout history, people in **5** _____ used pearls for medicine and philtres. There are essentially three types of pearls: natural, cultured and imitation. Natural and cultured pearls share a similar growing process, while imitation pearls are different. And **6** _____ owns the reputation for its imitation pearl industry.

The country **7** _____ usually produces the larger pearls due to the favourable environment along the coastline, while the nation of **8** _____ manufactures some of the most glistening cultured pearls.

In the past, the country **9** _____ in the Persian Gulf produced the world's best pearls. At present, the major remaining suppliers of natural pearls are in **10** _____.

A America	B Philippines	C Australia	D Bahrain
E China	F Japan	G India	H Egypt
I Myanmar	J Persia	K Mallorca	

Questions 11–13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1?

*In boxes **11–13** on your answer sheet, write:*

TRUE	if the statement agrees with the information
FALSE	if the statement contradicts the information
NOT GIVEN	if there is no information on this

11. A cultured pearl's centre is often significantly larger than that in a natural pearl.

12. Imitation pearls are usually the same price as natural ones.

13. Akoya pearls from Japan glow more deeply than South Sea pearls from Australia.

IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. **C** (Đoạn C nói về những khó khăn như trai bị chết vì bệnh, dị hình, hoặc từ chối vật kích thích).
2. **D** (Đoạn D giải thích kích thước phụ thuộc vào độ tuổi của con trai và vị trí nuôi cấy).
3. **A** (Đoạn A đề cập đến phong tục cổ xưa của người Ai Cập, Ba Tư và Trung Quốc).
4. **B** (Đoạn B phân biệt ngọc trai tự nhiên và nuôi cấy qua vật kích thích, đoạn E bổ sung cách phân biệt qua tia X).
5. **J (Persia)** - Người Ba Tư dùng bột ngọc trai để chữa bệnh).
6. **K (Mallorca)** - Hòn đảo ở Tây Ban Nha nổi tiếng với ngành ngọc trai giả).
7. **C (Australia)** - Vùng biển phía Nam của Úc thường tạo ra ngọc trai lớn hơn).
8. **F (Japan)** - Ngọc trai Akoya từ Nhật Bản có độ bóng cao nhất (P1 - The P... p. 2).
9. **D (Bahrain)** - Trong quá khứ, các quốc gia vùng Vịnh xung quanh Bahrain sản xuất ngọc trai tốt nhất thế giới .
10. **G (India)** - Hiện nay, kho dự trữ ngọc trai tự nhiên lớn nhất nằm ở Ấn Độ.
11. **TRUE**

    (Vật kích thích được cấy vào ngọc trai nuôi thường lớn hơn nhiều so với ngọc tự nhiên).
12. **FALSE**

    (Ngọc trai giả hầu như không có giá trị so với ngọc tự nhiên cực kỳ đắt đỏ).
13. **NOT GIVEN**

    (Bài đọc có nói ngọc Akoya rất bóng và ngọc Úc có kích thước lớn, nhưng không có sự so sánh trực tiếp xem loại nào "tỏa sáng sâu hơn").

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

The return of the black-footed ferret

The rise, fall, and rise of one of North America's rarest mammals

A The black-footed ferret (*Mustela nigripes*) is a small carnivorous mammal, similar in length to a domestic cat, and is the only ferret species native to North America. For at least 100,000 years they lived in an area that extended almost uninterrupted from southern Canada to northern Mexico. But numbers fell dramatically throughout the 19th and 20th centuries, to such an extent that the black-footed ferret was declared 'possibly extinct'. Then, almost miraculously, it returned from the dead.

B Within the genus *Mustela*, the ferret belongs to the subgenus *Putorius*, of which there are only three extant species: the European polecat; the Siberian polecat; and the black-footed ferret. The European polecat lives in open forests and meadows, and is thought to be the ancestor of the domestic ferret. The Siberian polecat looks more similar to the black-footed ferret, and leads a similar life on open grasslands and semi-desert regions across Russia, China and Siberia.

C Ferrets probably evolved in Europe between three and four million years ago, and dispersed into North America across an ice-age land bridge at least two million years ago. They then advanced south-eastward to the Great Plains through ice-free passageways. The black-footed ferret's history in North America is inextricably linked to the creature which became almost its sole prey — the prairie dog. These small rodents are a type of ground squirrel which live in networks of underground tunnels, known as burrows. The black-footed ferret's short legs and long, slim body make it superbly adapted for life in the burrow systems of its prey.

D Spending virtually all their time underground, black-footed ferrets have always been elusive. Ferrets are never mentioned in accounts of the early explorers or pioneers who crossed the Great Plains by wagon train during the early to mid-1800s. They were, however, occasionally listed in records kept by fur companies in the upper Missouri River basin during that period. Black-footed ferrets were not officially recognized by scientists until 1851, when a description and drawing of one featured in a book by the renowned naturalist John James Audubon and Reverend John Bachman. For over two decades, no other specimens were seen, and scientists even began to question their existence. Then, in 1874, a Dr Elliott Coues issued a request for specimens through the popular magazine *The American Sportsman*, and was soon rewarded. With these he was able to add to Audubon's description, and confirm the existence of the black-footed ferret.

E In the decades that followed, European settlement across North America changed the landscape dramatically, with vast areas being transformed into crop and grazing land. As agriculture and ranching expanded, the black-footed ferret's main prey, the prairie dog, became a target for extermination, and was eventually eradicated from 98% of its original

range. The result was devastating for black-footed ferret populations throughout the continent. Even today, the prairie dog is still trapped and poisoned, because ranchers believe that it competes with livestock for grass — a notion that belies recent research showing that prairie dogs and cattle feed on different plants.

F As late as the 1950s, black-footed ferrets were still thought to occur in low densities throughout most of their historic range. However, by the 1960s, the only known population was a small colony in south-western South Dakota. In 1967, the US Fish and Wildlife Service classified the black-footed ferret as an endangered species, and in 1974 the South Dakota colony disappeared. Finally, in January 1979, the last ferret in a captive-breeding programme died — making the black-footed ferret the first mammal to be declared extinct in the Northern Hemisphere in the 20th century.

G But that was not the end of the story. In 1981, a farm dog called Shep carried an odd-looking creature to its owner's ranch house in Meeteetse, Wyoming. The rancher put the carcass in his fridge and alerted state officials. The dog had found a black-footed ferret — which led to efforts again being made to save the species. An intensive search in the region led to the discovery of a 130-strong population. This wild colony thrived for a while, but disaster struck again and the number of animals was drastically reduced by the disease distemper — probably contracted from domestic dogs. In 1985, in a final bid to save the species, the remaining 18 individuals in the colony were trapped for a new captive-breeding programme. This project was successful, and there are now more than 2,000 black-footed ferrets in captivity across the US and Canada.

H A reintroduction programme began in 1991. Before they can be reintroduced into their natural habitat, captive ferrets have to learn to hunt and escape from predators. They are first held in pens on the prairie, where they are fed prairie dog meat. Once the ferrets associate these animals with food, keepers unleash live prey into the pens, and they soon realise that they must hunt or go hungry. Then, to get the ferrets used to living underground, they have to be tempted into the holes with food.

I Reintroduction programmes are now underway across central USA, but there is one location that is key. The Janos area on the US-Mexico border is the obvious place to reactivate the continent's wild black-footed ferret population, being one of the most important remaining grassland ecosystems in the Americas, and home to an abundance of prairie dogs. At the last report, the future of the black-footed ferret finally looks promising.

Questions 14–16

Complete the sentences below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 14–16 on your answer sheet.

14 The black-footed ferret shares most characteristics with its relative, the _____.

15 North American ferrets are thought to have originally come from _____.

16 The _____ is the black-footed ferret's primary source of food.

Questions 17–22

Look at the following events (Questions 17–22) and the list of dates below.

*Match each event with the correct date, **A–H**.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–H**, in boxes 17–22 on your answer sheet.*

17 An appeal for evidence of black-footed ferrets was published.

18 A scheme for releasing captive-born black-footed ferrets into the wild was launched.

19 The black-footed ferret first appeared in a scientific work.

20 The discovery of a single black-footed ferret led to renewed hope for the species.

21 North America's last wild-born black-footed ferrets were taken into captivity.

22 Efforts to save the black-footed ferret were officially announced as having failed.

List of Dates

A 1851
B 1874
C 1967
D 1974
E 1979
F 1981
G 1985
H 1991

Questions 23–26

Reading Passage 2 has nine paragraphs, **A–I**.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

*Write the correct letter, **A–I**, in boxes 23–26 on your answer sheet.*

23 reasons for the sharp decrease in black-footed ferret populations

24 the procedure by which black-footed ferrets are taught to survive in the wild

25 mention of doubts about whether there was such an animal as a black-footed ferret

26 reference to a site which is ideal for the release of black-footed ferrets into the wild

TRUE IELTS

ĐÁP ÁN

- **Câu 14:** The black-footed ferret shares most characteristics with its relative, the **Siberian polecat**.
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn B trong bài có viết: *"The Siberian polecat looks more similar to the black-footed ferret, and leads a similar life..."* (Chồn hoang Siberia trông giống với chồn chân đen hơn và có cuộc sống tương tự...). Cụm *"shares most characteristics"* (chia sẻ nhiều đặc điểm nhất) tương đương với *"looks more similar"* và *"leads a similar life"* trong bài.
- **Câu 15:** North American ferrets are thought to have originally come from **Europe**.
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn C trong bài viết: *"Ferrets probably evolved in Europe... and dispersed into North America..."* (Loài chồn này có thể đã tiến hóa ở Châu Âu... và phân tán sang Bắc Mỹ...). Cụm *"originally come from"* (nguồn gốc ban đầu từ) tương ứng với *"evolved in Europe"*.
- **Câu 16:** The **prairie dog** is the black-footed ferret's primary source of food.
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn C chỉ ra mối liên hệ thức ăn: *"...the creature which became almost its sole prey – the prairie dog."* (sinh vật gần như là con mồi duy nhất của nó – chó đồng cỏ). Cụm *"primary source of food"* (nguồn thức ăn chính) đồng nghĩa với *"almost its sole prey"*.
- **Câu 17:** An appeal for evidence of black-footed ferrets was published → **B (1874)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn D viết: *"Then, in 1874, a Dr Elliott Coues issued a request for specimens through the popular magazine..."* (Vào năm 1874, Tiến sĩ Elliott Coues đã đưa ra một yêu cầu thu thập các mẫu vật trên một cuốn tạp chí phổ biến...). Việc kêu gọi thu thập mẫu vật (*"request for specimens"*) chính là lời kêu gọi tìm kiếm bằng chứng về sự tồn tại của chúng (*"appeal for evidence"*).
- **Câu 18:** A scheme for releasing captive-born black-footed ferrets into the wild was launched → **H (1991)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn H viết: *"A reintroduction programme began in 1991."* (Một chương trình tái hòa nhập tự nhiên đã bắt đầu vào năm 1991). Việc thả chồn sinh ra trong môi trường nuôi nhốt về lại tự nhiên chính là *"reintroduction programme"*.
- **Câu 19:** The black-footed ferret first appeared in a scientific work → **A (1851)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn D viết: *"Black-footed ferrets were not officially recognized by scientists until 1851, when a description and drawing of one featured in a book..."* (Chồn chân đen không được các nhà khoa học công nhận chính thức cho đến năm 1851, khi bản mô tả và hình vẽ về nó xuất hiện trong một cuốn sách...).
- **Câu 20:** The discovery of a single black-footed ferret led to renewed hope for the species → **F (1981)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn G viết: *"In 1981, a farm dog called Shep carried an odd-looking creature... The dog had found a black-footed ferret — which led to efforts again being made to save the species."* (Vào năm 1981, một chú chó nông trại mang về một sinh vật kỳ lạ... nó là chồn chân đen, điều này mở ra những nỗ lực mới nhằm cứu lấy loài này).
- **Câu 21:** North America's last wild-born black-footed ferrets were taken into captivity → **G (1985)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn G viết: *"In 1985, in a final bid to save the species, the remaining 18 individuals in the colony were trapped for a new*

captive-breeding programme." (Vào năm 1985, trong nỗ lực cuối cùng để cứu loài này, 18 cá thể còn sót lại ngoài tự nhiên đã bị bẫy để đưa vào chương trình nhân giống nuôi nhốt mới).

- **Câu 22:** Efforts to save the black-footed ferret were officially announced as having failed → **E (1979)**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn F viết: *"Finally, in January 1979, the last ferret in a captive-breeding programme died — making the black-footed ferret the first mammal to be declared extinct..."* (Cuối cùng, vào tháng 1 năm 1979, cá thể chồn cuối cùng trong chương trình nuôi nhốt đã chết – khiến loài này bị tuyên bố tuyệt chủng). Việc bị tuyên bố tuyệt chủng (*"declared extinct"*) đồng nghĩa với việc các nỗ lực cứu vãn trước đó chính thức thất bại.
- **Câu 23:** Lý do số lượng chồn chân đen giảm mạnh (*reasons for the sharp decrease...*) → **Đoạn E**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn E giải thích nguyên nhân là do sự định cư của người châu Âu dẫn đến việc thay đổi cảnh quan thành đất nông nghiệp và chăn nuôi, kèm theo đó là chiến dịch tiêu diệt loài chó đồng cỏ (con mồi chính của chồn) trên 98% diện tích tự nhiên.
- **Câu 24:** Quy trình huấn luyện chồn để sống sót ngoài tự nhiên (*the procedure by which black-footed ferrets are taught to survive...*) → **Đoạn H**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn H mô tả chi tiết các bước huấn luyện (*procedure*): Đầu tiên chồn được nuôi trong chuồng trên thảo nguyên, cho ăn thịt chó đồng cỏ để quen mùi vị; tiếp theo người ta thả mồi sống vào để chúng học cách săn; cuối cùng là dùng thức ăn dụ chúng xuống các hang để làm quen với cuộc sống dưới lòng đất.
- **Câu 25:** Đề cập đến việc hoài nghi về sự tồn tại của loài chồn chân đen (*mention of doubts about whether there was such an animal...*) → **Đoạn D**
    - *Giải thích:* Đoạn D có câu: *"For over two decades, no other specimens were seen, and scientists even began to question their existence."* (Trong hơn hai thập kỷ, không một mẫu vật nào khác được tìm thấy, và các nhà khoa học thậm chí bắt đầu hoài nghi về sự tồn tại của chúng).
- **Câu 26:** Nhắc đến một địa điểm lý tưởng để thả chồn về lại tự nhiên (*reference to a site which is ideal for the release...*) → **Đoạn I**
    - *Giải thích:* Phần cuối đoạn I chỉ rõ: *"The Janos area on the US-Mexico border is the obvious place to reactivate the continent's wild black-footed ferret population..."* (Vùng Janos ở biên giới Mỹ–Mexico là một nơi rõ ràng/lý tưởng nhất để tái hoạt động quần thể chồn hoang dã...).

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

The Significant Role of Mother Tongue in Education

One consequence of population mobility is an increasing diversity within schools. To illustrate, in the city of Toronto in Canada, 58% of kindergarten pupils come from homes where English is not the usual language of communication. Schools in Europe and North America have experienced this diversity for years, and educational policies and practices vary widely between countries and even within countries. Some political parties and groups search for ways to solve the problem of diverse communities and their integration in schools and society. However, they see few positive consequences for the host society and worry that this diversity threatens the identity of the host society. Consequently, they promote unfortunate educational policies that will make the “problem” disappear. If students retain their culture and language, they are viewed as less capable of identifying with the mainstream culture and learning the mainstream language of the society.

The challenge for educators and policy-makers is to shape the evolution of national identity in such a way that the rights of all citizens (including school children) are respected, and the cultural, linguistic, and economic resources of the nation are maximised. To waste the resources of the nation by discouraging children from developing their mother tongues is quite simply unintelligent from the point of view of national self-interest. A first step in providing an appropriate education for culturally and linguistically diverse children is to examine what the existing research says about the role of children’s mother tongues in their educational development.

In fact, the research is very clear. When children continue to develop their abilities in two or more languages throughout their primary school, they gain a deeper understanding of language and how to use it effectively. They have more practice in processing language, especially when they develop literacy in both. More than 150 research studies conducted during the past 25 years strongly support what Goethe, the famous eighteenth-century German philosopher, once said: the person who knows only one language does not truly know that language. Research suggests that bilingual children may also develop more flexibility in their thinking as a result of processing information through two different languages.

The level of development of children's mother tongue is a strong predictor of their second language development. Children who come to school with a solid foundation in their mother tongue develop stronger literacy abilities in the school language. When parents and other caregivers (e.g., grandparents) are able to spend time with their children and tell stories or discuss issues with them in a way that develops their mother tongue, children come to school well-prepared to learn the school language and succeed educationally. Children's knowledge and skills transfer across languages from the mother tongue to the school language. Transfer across languages can be two-way: both languages nurture each other when the educational environment permits children access to both languages.

Some educators and parents are suspicious of mother tongue-based teaching programs because they worry that they take time away from the majority language. For example, in a bilingual program when 50% of the time is spent teaching through children's home language and 50% through the majority language, surely children won't progress as far in the latter? One of the most strongly established findings of educational research, however, is that well-implemented bilingual programs can promote literacy and subject-matter knowledge in a minority language without any negative effects on children's development in the majority language. Within Europe, the Foyer program in Belgium, which develops children's speaking and literacy abilities in three languages (their mother tongue, Dutch and French), most clearly illustrates the benefits of bilingual and trilingual education (see Cummins, 2000).

It is easy to understand how this happens. When children are learning through a minority language, they are learning concepts and intellectual skills too. Pupils who know how to tell the time in their mother tongue understand the concept of telling time. In order to tell time in the majority language, they do not need to re-learn the concept. Similarly, at more advanced stages, there is transfer across languages in other skills such as knowing how to distinguish the main idea from the supporting details of a written passage or story, and distinguishing fact from opinion. Studies of secondary school pupils are providing interesting findings in this area, and it would be worth extending this research.

Many people marvel at how quickly bilingual children seem to "pick up" conversational skills in the majority language at school (although it takes much longer for them to catch up with native speakers in academic language skills). However, educators are often much less aware of how quickly children can lose their ability to use their mother tongue, even in the home context. The extent and rapidity of language loss will vary according to the concentration of families from a particular linguistic group in the neighbourhood. Where the mother tongue is used extensively in the community, then language loss among young children will be less. However, where language communities are not concentrated in

particular neighbourhoods, children can lose their ability to communicate in their mother tongue within 2–3 years of starting school. They may retain receptive skills in the language but they will use the majority language in speaking with their peers and siblings and in responding to their parents. By the time children become adolescents, the linguistic division between parents and children has become an emotional chasm. Pupils frequently become alienated from the cultures of both home and school with predictable results.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 27–30

Choose the correct letter, ***A, B, C or D****.*

Write the correct letter in boxes 27–30 on your answer sheet.

27 What point did the writer make in the second paragraph?

A Some present studies on children's mother tongues are misleading.
B A culturally rich education programme benefits some children more than others.
C Bilingual children can make a valuable contribution to the wealth of a country.
D The law on mother tongue use at school should be strengthened.

28 Why does the writer refer to something that Goethe said?

A to lend weight to his argument
B to contradict some research
C to introduce a new concept
D to update current thinking

29 The writer believes that when young children have a firm grasp of their mother tongue

A They can teach older family members what they learnt at school.
B They go on to do much better throughout their time at school.
C They can read stories about their cultural background.
D They develop stronger relationships with their family than with their peers.

30 Why are some people suspicious about mother-tongue-based teaching programmes?

A They worry that children will be slow to learn to read in either language.
B They think that children will confuse words in the two languages.
C They believe that the programmes will make children less interested in their lessons.
D They fear that the programmes will use up valuable time in the school day.

Questions 31–35

*Complete the summary using the list of words, **A–J**, below.*

*Write the correct letter, **A–J**, in boxes 31–35 on your answer sheet.*

Bilingual Children

It was often recorded that bilingual children acquire the **31** _____ to converse in the majority language remarkably quickly. The fact that the mother tongue can disappear at a similar **32** _____ is less well understood. This phenomenon depends, to a certain extent, on the proportion of people with the same linguistic background who have settled in a particular **33** _____. If this is limited, children are likely to lose the active use of their mother tongue, and thus no longer employ it even with **34** _____, although they may still understand it. It follows that teenage children in these circumstances experience a sense of **35** _____ in relation to all aspects of their lives.

A teachers **B** school **C** dislocation **D** rate **E** time

F family **G** communication **H** type **I** ability **J** area

Questions 36–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 36–40 on your answer sheet, write

YES *if the statement agrees with the views of the writer*
NO *if the statement contradicts the views of the writer*
NOT GIVEN *if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

36 Less than half of the children who attend kindergarten in Toronto have English as their mother tongue.

37 Research proves that learning the host country language at school can have an adverse effect on a child's mother tongue.

38 The Foyer program is to be accepted by the French education system.

39 Bilingual children are taught to tell the time earlier than monolingual children.

40 Bilingual children can apply reading comprehension strategies acquired in one language when reading in the other.

ĐÁP ÁN:

27. C: Trẻ em song ngữ có thể đóng góp giá trị cho sự giàu có của một quốc gia (đoạn 2 nhấn mạnh việc phát triển tiếng mẹ đẻ giúp tối đa hóa tài nguyên kinh tế và lợi ích quốc gia).
o Location: Paragraph 2: "The challenge for educators... is to shape the evolution of national identity in such a way that the rights of all citizens... are respected, and the cultural, linguistic and economic resources of the nation are maximized."

28. A: Để củng cố thêm cho lập luận của mình (tác giả dẫn lời Goethe sau khi trích dẫn hơn 150 nghiên cứu để tăng sức thuyết phục).
o Location: Paragraph 3: "More than 150 research studies... strongly support what Goethe... once said..."

29. B: Trẻ em sẽ học tốt hơn trong suốt thời gian ở trường (có nền tảng tiếng mẹ đẻ tốt giúp chuẩn bị tốt cho ngôn ngữ ở trường và thành công trong giáo dục).
o Location: Paragraph 4: "...children come to school well-prepared to learn the school language and succeed educationally."

30. D: Họ lo ngại rằng các chương trình này sẽ tiêu tốn thời gian quý báu trong ngày học (lo sợ việc dạy tiếng mẹ đẻ lấy mất thời gian của ngôn ngữ chính).
o Location: Paragraph 5: "Some educators and parents are suspicious... because they worry that they take time away from the majority language."

31. I (ability): Trẻ em song ngữ có khả năng giao tiếp bằng ngôn ngữ chính rất nhanh.
o Location: Paragraph 7: "...how quickly bilingual children seem to 'pick up' conversational skills..."

32. D (rate): Thực tế là tiếng mẹ đẻ có thể biến mất với một tốc độ (**rate**) tương đương.
o Location: Paragraph 7: "...educators are often much less aware of how quickly children can lose their ability to use their mother tongue... The extent and rapidity of language loss will vary..."

33. J (area): Hiện tượng này phụ thuộc vào tỷ lệ người cùng ngôn ngữ định cư trong một khu vực (**area**) cụ thể.
o Location: Paragraph 7: "...depends to a certain extent on the concentration of families from a particular linguistic group in the neighborhood."

34. F (family): Trẻ em có thể không còn sử dụng tiếng mẹ đẻ ngay cả với gia đình (**family**), dù vẫn hiểu được.
o Location: Paragraph 7: "...they will use the majority language in speaking with their peers and siblings and in responding to their parents."

35. C (dislocation): Trẻ em ở độ tuổi thiếu niên trong hoàn cảnh này sẽ trải qua cảm giác lạc lõng/mất kết nối (**dislocation**) với mọi khía cạnh của cuộc sống.
o Location: Paragraph 7: "...the linguistic division between parents and children has become an emotional chasm. Pupils frequently become alienated from the cultures of both home and school..."

36. YES: Ít hơn một nửa số trẻ mẫu giáo ở Toronto có tiếng mẹ đẻ là tiếng Anh (vì 58% đến từ các gia đình không nói tiếng Anh thông thường).
o Location: Paragraph 1: "...in the city of Toronto in Canada, 58% of kindergarten pupils come from homes where English is not the language of communication."

37. NO: Nghiên cứu chứng minh rằng các chương trình song ngữ tốt giúp thúc đẩy biết chữ ở ngôn ngữ thiểu số mà không có tác động tiêu cực đến ngôn ngữ chính.
o Location: Paragraph 5: "...well-implemented bilingual programs can promote literacy and subject-matter knowledge in a minority language without any negative effects on children's development in the majority language."

38. NOT GIVEN: Bài đọc chỉ nhắc đến chương trình Foyer ở Bỉ, không đề cập đến việc nó có được hệ thống giáo dục Pháp chấp nhận hay không.
o Location: Paragraph 5 mentions the Foyer programme in Belgium.

39. NOT GIVEN: Bài đọc nói về việc "chuyển giao khái niệm" (biết xem giờ ở ngôn ngữ này thì không cần học lại ở ngôn ngữ kia), không so sánh ai học nhanh hơn.
o Location: Paragraph 6 mentions learning to tell the time.

40. YES: Trẻ em song ngữ có thể áp dụng các chiến lược đọc hiểu đã học ở ngôn ngữ này khi đọc ở ngôn ngữ kia (như phân biệt ý chính, sự thật và quan điểm).
o Location: Paragraph 6: "...at more advanced stages, there is transfer across languages in other skills, such as knowing how to distinguish the main idea from the supporting details of a written passage..."